

Literature

General Lit.
Lit./Mythology





About the Course

Overview note: Literature selections are chosen to encourage students to engage with rich ideas in literature and history and also to help them to gain independence in their reading and lessons.

This course includes the following topic(s): Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6, General Lit.: Grades 5-6

About General Lit.: Grades 5-6

Read living books full of memorable characters, surprising plot twists, and heartwarming endings. Due to the rise of Children's Literature in the 19th century, students read period literature rather than historical fiction this year and will spend about a term and a half each with *Little Women* and *Hans Brinker*.

About Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

Students read Roman, Norse, and Eastern mythology, Dickens' *A Christmas Carol*, and a selection of short stories and fairy tales written or collected in the 19th century.



Placement & Combining Tips

Literature: Grades 5-6

Overview note: Poetry lessons are an integral part of the whole Literature program, so look at both literature and poetry selections together when placing students.

General Lit.: Grades 5-6

Easily combined with Grade 4.

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

Suitable for hungry 4th graders. *A Christmas Carol* and some stories and tales shared with Grades 7-8.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
5-6	General Lit.: Grades 5-6 1 time/week 20 min	<i>Hans Brinker</i> or <i>The Silver Skates</i> <i>Little Women</i>
5-6	Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 1 time/week 25 min	<i>The Age of Fable</i> South American Jungle Tales Russian Fairy Tales <i>A Christmas Carol</i> Short Stories & Folktales

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grades 5-6				
Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6		General Lit.: Grades 5-6		



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

☐ Read the preface and introduction of *The Age of Fable* for background information about myths and the rationale for reading them.

☐ Print "Age of Fable Glossary" for easy access during lessons. Find the link in Quick Links below.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Literature: Grades 5-6

The Extra Helping writing prompts in the lessons are used as composition prompts in grades 7-8, and they are only for students who want to dive deeper or experiment with writing at this level.

General Lit.: Grades 5-6

☐ For the *Silver Skates*, we have provided two different pacing options for the book depending on your student(s) and context. The first pacing option is slower and better suited for less confident readers reading independently OR those reading the book aloud with their student(s). Note that students will want to finish this book on their own time after the end of the year.

The second pacing option moves more quickly and allows students to finish the book. This is best suited to quick readers or those who want to assign any reading not finished in a lesson for students to complete as homework on their own time during the term.

Regardless of which pacing option you choose, be sure to leave time for students to narrate at the end of the lesson. Note that recap and discussion questions are based on the slower pacing, so feel free to skip ahead and use a discussion question from a different lesson if you're following the faster option.

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

☐ *The Age of Fable* (Term 1) is best as a read-aloud or assigned as a stretch book for independent reading after the first few lessons are done together. Vocabulary may be difficult to understand, but it can be comprehended in context. Reference the glossary in Quick Links as needed. These stories reference imaginary creatures and ancient deities. It is a good idea to think ahead about how you might explain these characters if your students ask.

☐ *Tales* (Term 2) Older Folk Tales often include content such as drinking, smoking, abuse of others, etc. The teacher should preview the tales if this might be an issue for your home or classroom.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Literature: Grades 5-6

General Lit.: Grades 5-6



Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates



Little Women

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6



The Age of Fable



South American Jungle Tales



Russian Fairy Tales



A Christmas Carol

Short Stories & Folktales



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Literature: Grades 5-6

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

∞ [Age of Fable Glossary](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Literature: Grades 5-6

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance, especially for Shakespeare lessons. It is helpful to read the play or a preview of it beforehand.
- Choose which books to have students read independently. See Planning and Prep notes for recommendations.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember and/or predict what might come next. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, try showing an illustration, sharing something that you remember, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading and/or using a combination of visual and audio support this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage aloud or have students read independently. For Shakespeare, it is highly recommended that each student have their own copy of the play and that you read it aloud together or read along and underline/make notes while listening to the audio recording.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- Some students may benefit from having a notebook or piece of scrap paper available to externalize ideas by drawing, recording names, or making symbolic 'squiggle' notes.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Keep an eye out for things to add to your Book of Centuries, Citizenship Notebook, and Copywork book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or in writing. If writing, encourage students to use the full remaining lesson time and include as much detail as they can remember. For Shakespeare or

challenging books, it may be helpful to narrate more frequently and/or use props.

- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Students who used paper or a notebook to externalize may refer to these for support. Other students who need external support may benefit from looking at a map or picture from the book while narrating.
- Students who tend to use the same type of narration all the time can be encouraged to try another form of narration by first doing it together through play or discussion.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill that requires the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today; notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they tell you about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note or take a break for the day, if necessary.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you can ask an open-ended question or use an included discussion question.

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 1

Materials: Little Women

PREP: Read the bio and share parts with your students in the lesson.
∞ Article Link: Louisa May Alcott Bio

→ INTRO

Little Women was published in 2 volumes. We will read Volume 1, published originally in 1868. Little Women was the first American novel written for girls, though it had wide appeal upon publication, with boys, adult women, and men as well. It was a move away from overly preachy children's literature and was an immediate success, changing how novels for young people were written.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1 "Playing Pilgrims"

- If you read Pilgrim's Progress in younger grades, keep an eye out for many different references or allusions to the book as you read Little Women. Did you notice any in this chapter? [Hint: the name of the chapter is one reference!]

★ TEACHER NOTE

See Extra Helpings for suggested audio versions, as this can be a fun book to listen to in the afternoons or at other times to create flexibility in your schedule.

● IMPORTANT DATES

Little Women published (1868 AD)

WEEK 1 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 1

Adventures of Aeneas and Dido

Materials: Age of Fable

→ INTRO

Virgil wrote the Aeneid between 29 and 19 B.C. We will be reading stories and poetry from this epic work this term.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.31 p.207-213 "We have followed" - "to the Sibyl."

● COMPOSITION

Illustrate & Caption: Phineus and the Harpies or another scene.

WEEK 2 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 2

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

Who are the "Little Women" and what is the setting for the book?

→ INTRO

Name as many things as you can that are happening in the world during the late 1800s when Little Women was written and published.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2 "A Merry Christmas"

- How do the March sisters show joy despite their circumstances?

● EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: Christmas During the Civil War

WEEK 2 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 2

Elysium and the Sibyl

Materials: Age of Fable

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.32 p.213-221 "As at the" - "in number less."

● COMPOSITION

Act Out: The meeting of Aeneas and Dido in the land of the dead

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 3 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 3

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

What was Christmas like in the March home?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3 "The Laurence Boy"

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: Civil War Dresses

WEEK 3 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 3

Introduction to Infant Rome

Materials: Age of Fable

→ RECAP: WHAT DO YOU REMEMBER ABOUT HOW THE UNDERWORLD WAS DESCRIBED IN THE LAST CHAPTER?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.33 p.221-230 "Aeneas, having parted" - "along the main."

WEEK 4 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 4

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

Who did the March sisters meet in the last chapter? What is he like?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4 "Burdens"

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Link: The Alcotts' Home, which was the inspiration for the Marchs' home.

• Describe some of the burdens the sisters feel they carry. Which seems hardest to you?

WEEK 4 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 4

Pythagoras

Materials: Age of Fable

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.34 p.230-248 "The teachings of" - "were no more."

→ VIEW

Here is a bust of Pythagoras.

∞ Image Link: Pythagoras

• COMPOSITION

Illustrate & Tell: The death of Osiris or another scene.

WEEK 5 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 5

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

What are some of the chores or work the sisters are responsible for?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 "Being Neighborly"

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: Transcendentalism and the Alcotts

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Read this memorial poem about Thoreau by Alcott.

∞ Link: Thoreau's Flute

Read about the link between Alcott and Ralph Waldo Emerson in the article linked below.

∞ Article Link: Alcott and Emerson

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 5 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 5

Origin of Mythology & The Minerva of the Parthenon

Materials: Age of Fable

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.35 p.241-249 "Having reached the" - "fame have immortality."

→ VIEW

Here is one artist's image of Jupiter and a Roman statue of Minerva.

∞ Image Link: Jupiter

∞ Image Link: Minerva

• COMPOSITION

Expository: Tell at least three theories on the origins of mythology.

WEEK 6 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 6

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

How did Jo show kindness to a neighbor?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6-7 "Beth Finds the Palace Beautiful" and "Amy's Valley of Humiliation"

• Optional: Have you been noticing the allusions to Pilgrim's Progress? What kind of journey are each of the sisters on, and how is that similar (or dissimilar) to the Pilgrim's journey?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Pickled Limes

WEEK 6 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 6

Modern Monsters

Materials: Age of Fable

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.36 p.250-256 "There is a" - "these sacred fires?"

WEEK 7 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 7

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

What lesson did Amy learn in the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8 "Jo Meets Apollyon"

• What are some of the lessons about anger and temper in this chapter? Do you agree?

• EXTRA HELPING

Pick a scene from the story thus far to turn into a short play.

WEEK 7 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 7

Eastern Mythology & Siva

Materials: Age of Fable

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.37 p.256-264 "Our knowledge of" - "Quiloo and Melind."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Vishnu

∞ Image Link: Brahma

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 8 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 8

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

What lesson did Jo learn in the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9 "Meg Goes to Vanity Fair"

- What temptations does Meg face, and how does she recover?

WEEK 8 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 8

Loki and His Progeny

Materials: Age of Fable

→ INTRO

In the last several years, the popularity of Marvel comic movies has revived the popularity of mythological characters like Thor and Loki.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.38 p.264-269 "The stories" - "long into Niffleheim."

• COMPOSITION

Descriptive: Describe Thor.

WEEK 9 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 9

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

What lesson did Meg learn in the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10 "The P.C. and P.O."

- If you wrote something for the Pickwick Portfolio, what would you write?

• EXTRA HELPING

Write up your idea that you discussed in the lesson! Compose an advertisement, article, or poem for the Pickwick Portfolio. You can retell a scene from Little Women or choose something from another book or even your personal experience to write about. One idea: write a newspaper entry about the admission of "Sam Weller" into the club.

WEEK 9 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 9

Thor's Visit to Jotunheim

Materials: Age of Fable

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.39 p.269-275 "Once upon a" - "a verdant plain."

→ VIEW

Look at this runestone, which was carved during the Viking age. The three figures in the center are Odin (with the spear), Thor (with the hammer), and Freyr (with the sickle).

∞ Image Link: Runestone of Norse Mythology

• COMPOSITION

Written Retelling: Thor's Visit to Jotunheim

WEEK 10 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 10

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

Describe the Pickwick Club. Would you want to join?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

Ch.11 "Experiments"

- Why do the experiments fail, and what lessons do the girls learn?

WEEK 10 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 10

The Death of Baldur & Ragnarok

Materials: Age of Fable

→ INTRO

It is amazing that these rune stones can still be seen today. Most were engraved during the Viking age, making them around 1,000 years old.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.40 p.276-282 "Baldur the Good" - "by the Northmen!"

WEEK 11 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 11

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

What was the "experiment" in the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12 "Camp Laurence"

★ TEACHER NOTE

This is a longer chapter and can be finished in the afternoon or next week during exam week.

WEEK 11 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 11

The Druids

Materials: Age of Fable

→ INTRO

It is hard to believe that some festivals we read about still occur in Scotland today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.41 p.282-288 "The Druids were" - "but witness mine!"

WEEK 12 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Little Women

★ TEACHER NOTE

Finish chapter from last week as needed.

WEEK 12 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Age of Fable

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 13

Materials: Little Women

→ INTRO

What does your "dream future" look like 5 or 10 years from now?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13 "Castles in the Air"

• EXTRA HELPING

Write a profile or character sketch of one of the sisters. What are they like? Write as if you were telling a friend about them.

WEEK 1 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 13

Materials: South American Jungle Tales

→ INTRO

For centuries, people shared stories out loud around fires, at celebrations, and before bed. By the 1800s, many people worried these beloved tales were disappearing as the world rapidly changed around them, so collectors began writing them down. The Brothers Grimm gathered folk tales across Germany, Hans Christian Andersen turned Danish traditions into fairy tales, and Andrew Lang collected stories from countries all over the world. In America, people began recording the stories of Indigenous communities and formerly enslaved people. Now it's your turn to explore these timeless tales and discover the stories people have treasured for generations. We'll start our journey in South America with a tale about a lazy bee.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Lazy Bee" - Read from beginning to "inside a hollow tree."

- What do you think will happen next?

→ MAP WORK

Find the continent of South America on a map or globe. Our first tale takes place in the country of Argentina. See if you can find Argentina on your map. (The story mentioned the city of Misiones. Misiones is actually not a city, but is one of the provinces of Argentina.)

★ TEACHER NOTE

The world of folk tales is vast. Explore extra helpings for other tales to include or substitute as desired. For instance, Favorite African Folk Tales by Nelson Mandela features many short tales that could easily be added to a lesson or enjoyed as a read-aloud.

Note that the final two lessons of the term are a Christmas tale. Feel free to swap around the order of the tales if needed to read that story closer to Christmas.

WEEK 2 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 14

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

What were some of the sisters' dreams in the previous chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.232-253 "Jo was very busy"- "call her mother"

- How does Alcott use the contrasting personalities of the sisters as foils? A foil is when an author contrasts two characters to emphasize some of their qualities. The word foil refers to backing gems with foil to make them shine brighter.

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

With the remaining time or in the afternoon, learn more about the telegraph.

∞ Video Link: The Telegraph: The Civil War Text Machine

• IMPORTANT DATES

Telegraph invented (1830s)

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: LMA, Civil War Nurse



Term 2

WEEK 2 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 14

Materials: South American Jungle Tales

→ RECAP

What happened to the little bee in the first part of the story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Lazy Bee" - Read "And now the little bee" to the end of the story.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Sensitive Plant

- What was the lesson the little bee learned? Do you agree?

WEEK 3 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 15

Materials: Little Women

→ INTRO

What does good comfort look and feel like? What are ways you've been comforted when sad or ways that people have tried to comfort you unhelpfully?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.253-274 "Everything was arranged" - end of Ch.16

• EXTRA HELPING

Write a letter to Jo comforting her during Beth's illness.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Beth likely had Scarlet Fever. Share from or view this short video as desired.

∞ Video Link: Scarlet Fever

WEEK 3 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 15

Materials: South American Jungle Tales

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Giant Tortoise's Golden Rule"

- What was the moral or lesson in this story?

→ MAPWORK

Our last tale took place in the South American country of Argentina. This tale includes a man from Buenos Aires, which is the capital city of Argentina. See if you can find Buenos Aires on a map.

WEEK 4 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 16

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.17-18 "Little Faithful" & "Dark Days"

- Make a character chart of Amy's virtues versus her vanities.

WEEK 4 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 16

Materials: South American Jungle Tales

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS:

"How The Flamingos Got Their Stockings"

- Many folk tales come up with funny pretend stories about how something came to be. If you wrote a tale like this, what would it be about?



Term 2

→ MAPWORK

The author of South American Jungle Tales was from the country of Uruguay, also in South America. Can you find Uruguay on the map?

WEEK 5 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 17

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

How did the sisters show care for others in the previous chapters?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.19-20 "Amy's Will" & "Confidential"

- In what ways did Alcott use the literary device of foreshadowing leading up to Beth's illness? Foreshadowing is when an author gives us hints or clues about what might happen later in the story.
- In what ways does Little Women show that life can be good even through trials and tragedies?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Tell about Amy's will from Laurie's point of view, being sure to include what he might have been thinking.

∞ **Article Link:** Autobiographical Roots of Little Women

WEEK 5 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 17

Materials: Russian Fairy Tales

→ INTRO

Our next tales come from Russia. Russia is a vast land with a rich culture full of art, music, poetry, and storytelling stretching back hundreds of years. Its folk tales offer a window into a culture that loved nature, prized humility, and understood that life held both joy and hardship. Heroes in these stories are often humble and kind rather than powerful and proud, and magic is woven naturally into the everyday world. As you read, remember that you are not just enjoying a good story, but catching a glimpse of a way of life.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Tsar Sultan: Read from the beginning to "written in a tale."

- Does this fairy tale remind you of any others you have heard?

→ MAPWORK

Find Russia on a map. The land occupied by Russia has changed over many years. In the 1800's, Russia even owned the land that is now the state of Alaska. Russia sold Alaska to the United States in 1867, though it didn't become a state until almost 100 years later, in 1959.

WEEK 6 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 18

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

Describe what you've learned about Amy.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.21 "Laurie Makes Mischief, and Jo Makes Peace"

- Were you satisfied with the resolution of the prank in this chapter? Why or why not? If not, how might you have resolved it differently?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Volume 1 of Little Women has two more chapters: "Pleasant Meadows" and "Aunt March Settles the Question." Please have your student read these on their own time if they would like to finish Volume 1. In the next lesson, your student will begin reading Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates.

• EXTRA HELPING

In Ch.21 Jo says, "'Hold your tongue! . . . I came here to moralize, not to hear about things that make me skip to think of.'"

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

		Explain why you think she said this.
WEEK 6	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 18 Materials: Russian Fairy Tales → RECAP What has happened to the Tsaritsa and her son so far? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Tsar Sultan: Read "They entered it" to the end of the tale. What part of the tale was most surprising to you? Most interesting? Why?	EXTRA HELPINGS The George MacDonald Christmas Collection is a good choice if you'd like to substitute a tale during the Christmas season. ∞ Link: George MacDonald Christmas Collection
WEEK 7	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 19 Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates → INTRO Following the Civil War, the American public was in dire need of a pleasant distraction. Hans Brinker offered this escape and became an instant bestseller, second only to Charles Dickens in sales. Mary Mapes Dodge made a lasting change in children's literature both as the author of Hans Brinker and editor of St. Nicholas magazine. She brought some of the finest writers of her day to young readers and helped make writing for children lively, thoughtful, and full of imagination. This story is set in Holland. The Netherlands is the official name of the entire country, while Holland makes up two provinces within the country - North and South Holland. Optional: View Holland on this map. (Scroll down to see the map.) ∞ Map Link: The Netherlands → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.1-2 OR Ch.1-3 What have you already learned about Holland?	★ TEACHER NOTE Choose which pacing option to follow based on the ability and interest of your student(s). See Planning & Prep notes for more details on each option. • TERMINOLOGY ∞ Article Link: Hans Brinker Pronunciation & Corrections (shared with permission) • EXTRA HELPING Click "See More" near the top of this page to read a short bio of the author. ∞ Article Link: Mary Mapes Dodge Bio
WEEK 7	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 19 Materials: Russian Fairy Tales → INTRO Have you noticed that folk and fairy tales from different countries can feel really similar? There are a few reasons for this. First, all people share the same feelings like love, fear, and hope, so it makes sense that stories all over the world are about the same kinds of things. Second, people have always traveled, traded, and talked to each other. When they did, they shared their stories, too. A tale from one place could travel to another and get changed a little along the way. Third, these tales were told out loud long before anyone wrote them down. As stories got passed from grandparent to parent to child, they slowly changed but kept the same basic ideas. Fourth, many of these tales have the same types of characters, such as a brave hero, a mean villain, or a wise helper. These feel familiar to everyone, no matter where they're from. Finally, folk and fairy tales teach lessons like be honest, be kind, and be brave. Those are values every culture cares about! Our next tale about a	



Term 2

prince and a frog has appeared in many forms around the world. See if you can find connections to other tales you've heard before.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Frog-Tsarevna" - Read from the beginning to "show thee to the people as my wife."

- Does this fairy tale remind you of any others you have heard?
- If you could ask a character in the story a question, which character would it be, and what would you ask?

WEEK 8 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 20

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ MAP WORK

Use your atlas or view this map and find Amsterdam, the capital city of the Netherlands. You may want to print the map and tuck it in the book to refer to as you read.

∞ Map Link: Netherlands Map

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3-4

OR

Ch.4-6

- How would you describe Hans and Gretel to a friend?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Dutch Windmill Inside

WEEK 8 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 20

Materials: Russian Fairy Tales

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen when the frog appears at the Tsar's palace the next day?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Frog-Tsarevna" - Read "Weep no more" to the end of the story.

- What key values (such as bravery) did you notice in the story? Which character had this value?

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is a brief mention of a servant being beaten in the assigned reading.

WEEK 9 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 21

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

How did Hans and Gretel find a friend?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5-7

OR

Ch.7-9

- What "shadows" hang over the Brinker home?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Traditional Dutch Winter Skating

WEEK 9 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 21

Materials: Kipling

→ INTRO

Rudyard Kipling's stories have delighted children for over a hundred years and inspired writers like C.S. Lewis and Tolkien. However, Kipling lived

★ TEACHER NOTE

Be sure to preview before handing children Kipling's other stories.

The story in the next lesson can be borrowed on Internet Archive



Term 2

during the era of the British Empire and held attitudes toward other cultures that we recognize today as unfair and hurtful. This is something worth keeping in mind as you read his work, but thankfully, some of his stories are just interesting and fun. Today, we will read his tale of a hungry whale and a very clever sailor on the high seas.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: "How the Whale Got His Throat"

- Did this story remind you of a Bible story you have heard before? If so, how are they alike and different?
- What character traits did the Mariner show that helped him get out of trouble?

and is also available in the book linked below under the title "Papa's Story."

∞ Link: Papa's Story

∞ Link: George MacDonald Christmas Collection

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Write your tale down!

WEEK 10 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 22

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Hans and Gretel's parents?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8-9

OR

Ch.10-11

- What does the boys' plan to skate nearly fifty miles reveal about them and the time they live in?

→ VIEW

St. Nicholas illustration from St. Nicholas magazine, where Mary Mapes Dodge served as editor.

∞ Image Link: St. Nicholas Illustration

• LITERATURE CONNECTION

Louisa May Alcott (of Little Women fame) wrote for the St. Nicholas magazine!

WEEK 10 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 22

Materials: "Papa's Christmas Story" (aka A Scot's Christmas Story) by George MacDonald

→ INTRO

George MacDonald was a Scottish storyteller (1823-1905). He loved fairy tales and fantasy, and even inspired C.S. Lewis, who wrote The Chronicles of Narnia! MacDonald was a devoted Christian, and his faith showed in his writing. He loved Christmas so much that he would carol through the streets with his children and sometimes invite over a hundred strangers into his home to celebrate! He wrote Christmas poems, songs, and stories to share that joy with others. Today you're going to read one of his Christmas stories called "Papa's Story" (sometimes called "A Scot's Christmas"). In it, a father tells his children a tale on Christmas Eve. As you read, think about what lessons might be hiding inside, just like the other tales we have read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Papa's Christmas Story" (aka A Scot's Christmas Story) by George MacDonald

p.40-48 til "He soon fell asleep."

∞ Link: "Papa's Christmas Story"

- What do you think Nelly has made up her mind to do?

→ MAPWORK (OPTIONAL)

This tale takes place in Scotland. Find Scotland on a map or globe.

★ TEACHER NOTE

This story can be borrowed on Internet Archive and is also available in this book under the title "Papa's Story."

∞ Link: George MacDonald Christmas Collection

There is a mention of drinking alcohol in the assigned reading.



Term 2

WEEK 11 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 23

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10-11

OR

Ch.12-15

- How do Dutch customs of the Saint Nicholas celebration compare to your own Christmas celebrations?

• EXTRA HELPING

Virtually browse some of the art mentioned in this chapter if time allows.

∞ Link: Rijksmuseum Art

WEEK 11 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 23

Materials: "Papa's Christmas Story" (aka A Scot's Christmas Story) by George MacDonald

→ RECAP

What did Nelly dream about?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.48 "When Nelly thought" - p.60 (end of story)

- Did this story remind you of a Bible story you have heard before? If so, how are they alike and different?
- Why do you think MacDonald chose to tell this kind of story at Christmas? What does it have to do with the meaning of the holiday?

→ MAPWORK

Nelly traveled to Edinburgh, which is the capital city of Scotland. See if you can find Edinburgh on a map.

WEEK 12 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Little Women

WEEK 12 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Folk Tales from lessons



Term 3

WEEK 1 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 25

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the Saint Nicholas celebrations?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12-13

OR

Ch.16-18

→ MAP WORK

Use your atlas or view this map and find Haarlem.

∞ Map Link: Netherlands Map

- How would you have responded to the "catastrophe" if you had been with the boys?

WEEK 1 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 25

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ INTRO

A Christmas Carol is a novella, which is longer than a short story but shorter than a novel. It was published on December 19, and the first edition sold out by Christmas Eve, making it an immediate success. Like much of Dickens' writing, the story is a commentary on the social problems of his era, such as poverty, child welfare, and poor working conditions.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-11 Beginning to "closed it with a bang."

- Why do you think Scrooge dislikes Christmas so much?

★ TEACHER NOTE

See extra helpings for suggested audio versions, as this can be a fun book to listen to. Feel free to move reading this book closer to Christmas.

• IMPORTANT DATES

1843 AD: A Christmas Carol published

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Life In A Victorian Workhouse

WEEK 2 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 26

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What happened in the catastrophe? What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.14-15

OR

Ch.19-21

- What different kinds of homes are described?
- Why does Gretel struggle with her feelings about her father?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Historic Dutch Home Tour

WEEK 2 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 26

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

How would you describe Scrooge so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.11-21 "The sound resounded" - "upon the instant." (end of stave one)

- Why does Scrooge try so hard to explain away Marley's ghost?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: How A Christmas Carol Became A Holiday Classic

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 3 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 27

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the Brinker home?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16-17

OR

Ch.22-23

- Why do you think the author includes so many details about the places the boys visit?

WEEK 3 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 27

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.22-32 Beginning of Stave two- "upon a winter's night."

- What was Christmas like when Scrooge was young?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: 10 Things To Know about Charles Dickens' Christmas Carol

WEEK 4 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 28

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What was the meaning of the "man with four heads"?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.18-19

OR

Ch.24-26

- What dangers or freedoms come with spending so much time on the ice?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Can a Finger Really be Used to Stop a Leaky Dike?

WEEK 4 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 28

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What mood was Scrooge in when we left off? Notice how his mood changes through stave two.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.32-39 "In came a fiddler" - end of Stave two

- Why were the scenes with Belle so painful for Scrooge?

• EXTRA HELPING

Compare Scrooge and Fezziwig as employers. What do the actions of each show about leadership and responsibility for your employees?

∞ Video Link: Why Read Charles Dickens?

WEEK 5 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 29

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What happened last on the canal?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

★ TEACHER NOTE

The next lesson includes an optional video for traditional Dutch gingerbread (a five-ingredient quick bread). Look ahead and gather ingredients if you would like to make your own.

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

Ch.20-21
OR
Ch.27-28

- How do group plans reveal who is flexible, selfish, cautious, or brave?

WEEK 5 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 29

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What did the Ghost of Christmas Past show Scrooge?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.40-51 Stave three - "blushed to hint at such a thing."

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Charles Dickens' Home Tour

WEEK 6 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 30

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the Red Lion so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.22-23

OR

Ch.29-32

- How does the author mix comedy and danger? Why do you think she chose to do that?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

With the remaining time or in the afternoon, learn how to make traditional Dutch gingerbread.

∞ Video Link: Traditional Dutch Gingerbread

WEEK 6 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 30

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What did Scrooge learn by visiting the Cratchit family?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.51-64 "At last the dinner" - end of Stave three

- What do you think the children Ignorance and Want represent?

• EXTRA HELPING

The Ghost of Christmas Present shows Scrooge two suffering children named Ignorance and Want. What do these children represent, and why do you think Dickens showed them in such a shocking way?

∞ Video Link: Dickens' London

WEEK 7 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 31

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

How did the Red Lion become dangerous? What was the resolution?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.24-25

OR

Ch.33-36

→ MAP WORK

Use your atlas or view this map and find Leiden (Leyden is an older spelling).

• EXTRA HELPING

The "Egyptian Museum" is likely the Rijksmuseum van Oudheden.

∞ Link: Rijksmuseum van Oudheden

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

∞ Map Link: Netherlands Map

- How can visiting museums help us better understand the people, history, and culture of a place?

WEEK 7 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 31

📄 Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

Which ghosts have visited Scrooge so far? Who do you think will visit next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.65-76 Stave four - "there is your father at the door!"

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: The Story of A Christmas Carol and Victorian England

WEEK 8 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 32

📄 Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What did the boys see in Leyden?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.26-27

OR

Ch.37-40

- How does the quote "it is no sin to love beautiful things if you adapt your material to circumstances" help us think about enjoying beauty wisely?

WEEK 8 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 32

📄 Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.76-89 "She hurried out" - end of stave five.

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: How A Christmas Carol Perfectly Demonstrates 5-Act Structure (Note that this is the same structure as many of Shakespeare's plays.)

WEEK 9 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 33

📄 Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What stories were shared in the last lesson?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.28-29

OR

Ch.41-42

→ MAP WORK

Use your atlas or view this map and find The Hague.

∞ Map Link: Netherlands Map

- Why is a day of rest important in the story?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: The Hague Market Today



Term 3

WEEK 9 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 33

→ INTRO

The next 3 weeks are open for you to watch The Man Who Invented Christmas about the life of Charles Dickens. If you have already seen the movie or decide not to watch it, then use this time to catch up on your other subjects or read another classic from this time period such as Alice in Wonderland or pick a short story by Sir Arthur Conan Doyle such as The Speckled Band or The Redheaded League.

∞ Link: Alice in Wonderland

∞ Link: The Speckled Band

∞ Link: The Redheaded League

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: The Man Who Invented Christmas
Watch Movie

WEEK 10 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 34

📄 Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What happened during the visit to The Hague?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.30-31

OR

Ch.43-44

- As they head home, what has changed because of their journey?

WEEK 10 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 34

→ INTRO

This week is open for you to watch The Man Who Invented Christmas about the life of Charles Dickens. If you have already seen the movie or decide not to watch it, then use this time to catch up on your other subjects or read another classic from this time period such as Alice in Wonderland or pick a short story by Sir Arthur Conan Doyle such as The Speckled Band or The Redheaded League.

∞ Link: Alice in Wonderland

∞ Link: The Speckled Band

∞ Link: The Redheaded League

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: The Man Who Invented Christmas
Watch Movie

WEEK 11 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 35

📄 Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What happened as the boys headed home?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.32-33

OR

Ch.45-48

- Why is it sometimes difficult to hope when a situation feels uncertain?
- How can friendship help someone going through tough times?

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 11 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 35

→ INTRO

This week is open for you to watch The Man Who Invented Christmas about the life of Charles Dickens. If you have already seen the movie or decide not to watch it, then use this time to catch up on your other subjects or read another classic from this time period such as Alice in Wonderland or pick a short story by Sir Arthur Conan Doyle such as The Speckled Band or The Redheaded League.

∞ Link: Alice in Wonderland

∞ Link: The Speckled Band

∞ Link: The Redheaded League

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: The Man Who Invented Christmas
Watch Movie

WEEK 12 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ READ & DISCUSS

Ch.34-35

OR

Finish the book over exam week as needed.

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: Elfstedentocht:
The Famed Frozen Race

WEEK 12 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from: A Christmas Carol

Literature: Grades 5-6

Examination

Term 1

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

- In writing or picture, describe a scene from the adventures of Aeneas OR the story of Isis and Osiris.
- Describe Ragnarok in words or pictures.

General Lit.: Grades 5-6

- Little Women: Pilgrim's Progress is referred to multiple times in the book. Explain Jo's Apollyon in Ch.8, Meg's Vanity Fair in Ch.9, or discuss other parallels to Pilgrim's Progress that you've seen.

Sir Gibbie: If you have painted scenes from the story each week for your narrations, then write one of your favorite parts of the story so far. If you have told someone about the story each week for your narration, then paint or write about one of your favorite parts or scenes from the story so far.

Term 2

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

- Tell about a favorite fairy or folk tale you read this term and what lesson or moral the tale was trying to share.
- Why do tales from different countries and cultures have things in common with each other? Give some examples of similar tales.

General Lit.: Grades 5-6

- Act out one of your favorite scenes from Little Women.

Term 3

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

- A Christmas Carol: Explain how Scrooge changes from the beginning to the end of A Christmas Carol. What helps him change the most? Use examples from the story.

General Lit.: Grades 5-6

- Hans Brinker: Explain two ways that Hans and Gretel show responsibility and care for their family. What do their actions tell us about the kind of people they are? OR Describe two places the boys visit during their trip and explain what they see or experience at each one.